

DIPLOMA IN SOCIAL SERVICE

Social Service Programme Development

SSC-PMT-4022-1.1

Reflective Practice

Assignment Cover Sheet

Name of Candidate TAN VIE MING	Host Organisation
Name of Assessor	Contact Details 98891383
Name of IA Supervisor	Date of Submission
CANDIDATE'S DECLARATION a. I, hereby declare that all the entries in this journal are my own effort and do not involve plagiarism or works of other people whose services I have engaged. b. I have not allowed, and will not allow anyone to copy any of my Written Assignments with the intention of passing it off as his/her own works. Signature: _____ Date: _____ <i>*Attach this Assignment Cover sheet to your RP journal.</i>	

Introduction to Reflective Practice Assignment

A reflective journal is a personal record of your learning experiences. It is a tool which enables you to record and reflect upon your observations and responses to situations, which can then be used later to explore and analyse ways of thinking and being in contexts. Journals, although generally written, can also contain images, drawings and other types of reference materials.

This Reflective Journal uses the basic framework for self-reflection which is *description, reflect and application*. For this Reflective Practice assignment, you are required to complete this reflective journal of experiences gathered during the industrial attachment.

Instructions

Pre-Attachment

1. You will be assigned to a Host Organisation (HO) for your industrial attachment (IA). A HO supervisor will be appointed to mentor you.
2. If you have any questions regarding the entries in the RPJ, email your assessor for clarifications.
3. HMTA office will contact you to book the date for the Final Assessment before the IA. The date and timeslot selected by you is final. Any changes may incur an administrative fee.

During Attachment

4. A week prior to your IA, craft some guiding questions related to the TSC listed in the journal. You may gather in groups of 2 or 3 to design the questions. These questions will help you to target the areas you would like to learn during the attachment.
5. Preferable to make an appointment with your IA-Supervisor within the first week of attachment to gather the information related to the TSC. In addition, reflect on your work roles (if any) performed each workday which are related to any of the TSC in the RP journal.
6. Document the information gathered from your IA-supervisor, your personal

observations or the work roles you performed every day in Column 2 of the RPJ for the respective modules.

7. The writing of the RPJ is an individual and personal assignment.

8. The RPJ should be used to explore situations from a personal perspective, but generally within the context of learning from your experiences. Write your personal reflections in Column 3 on the information gathered in Column 2 of the RPJ. To guide you in writing your entry, you may find the following sample questions useful:

- *Is there a framework?*
(a) If no, why not? What would you have recommended to the HO?
(b) If yes, does it serve its intended purpose? Is there a set of principles to guide the organisation in managing the framework? What would you have recommended to the HO?
- *What were the incidents? What were the outcomes? Were these incidents preventable? If yes, what could be done differently to prevent the incidents?*

9. You are advised to make your entries after each workday and at your own pace.

Post-Attachment

10. Email the RPJ to your assessor **5 days after the end of the industrial attachment** and **cc to the Course Co-ordinator**.

During RP Presentation

11. You have 30 mins to present your entries for each module to the assessor. The following sequence is recommended:

- Provide a brief overview of the information gathered.
- Share your thoughts and feelings on what you have learnt.
- Highlight your key learning points from your experience.

12. Assessor may pose a few questions to clarify your entries.

13. You must demonstrate competency in both the RPJ and the RP presentation, in order to be deemed competent for this RP.

Quality of the Journal Entries

Entries should:

- be clear and reflect your ability to think critically and objectively.
- be in complete sentences. You are allowed to number or bullet your entries for easy reading.
- demonstrate you have acquired the respective technical skills and competencies of this module.
- journal all interactions, experiences, thoughts and relevant information which are deemed relevant
- not breach client confidentiality
- avoid using names when referring to people at the workplace

Learning Outcomes & Technical Skills and Competencies	Design 2 guiding Questions per row	Summarise the Information	Reflect on the information and pen your observations, thoughts, and experiences in relation to the respective LOs and TSC.
LO1 Conduct needs assessment for clients or community stakeholders to determine the scope of services or programmes to be provided to meet their needs. <u>TSC</u> K1 Community development frameworks, principles and models.	1) What is a community needs assessment? 2) How does it link to the needs-based community development model and Principle of Felt Needs?	A community needs assessment is a way to look closely at what services a community has and what it needs. It helps us: 1. Identify where services are lacking or not good enough to meet people's needs and concerns. 2. Create a clear plan to build and offer the right services that will fill these gaps and support everyone in the community.	

Learning Outcomes & Technical Skills and Competencies	Design 2 guiding Questions per row	Summarise the Information	Reflect on the information and pen your observations, thoughts, and experiences in relation to the respective LOs and TSC.
LO2 Adapt and incorporate best practices and trends to develop innovative social services programmes that meet the needs of clients or community stakeholders. <u>TSC</u> A7 Adapt and incorporate best practices and trends in programmes. K4 Trends and best practices in social service programmes.			
LO3 Develop strategies to engage the programme stakeholders in the social service sector to garner their support for the social service programmes or services. <u>TSC</u>			

Learning Outcomes & Technical Skills and Competencies	Design 2 guiding Questions per row	Summarise the Information	Reflect on the information and pen your observations, thoughts, and experiences in relation to the respective LOs and TSC.
K8 Strategies to engage programme stakeholders.			

LO1 Conduct needs assessment for clients or community stakeholders to determine the scope of services or programmes to be provided to meet their needs.

TSC

K1 Community development frameworks, principles and models.

1) What is a community needs assessment?

A community needs assessment is a way to look closely at what services a community has and what it needs.

It helps us:

1. Identify where services are lacking or not good enough to meet people's needs and concerns.
2. Create a clear plan to build and offer the right services that will fill these gaps and support everyone in the community.

2) How does it link to the needs-based community development model and Principle of Felt Needs?

The **needs-based community development model** is a strategic approach that centers on identifying and addressing the specific needs of a community. This model involves a systematic assessment of the community's challenges, gaps in services, and areas where improvements are necessary. The goal is to develop targeted programs and interventions that directly respond to these identified needs.

The principle of felt needs emphasizes that community development efforts should prioritize the needs that are recognized and expressed by the community members themselves. This principle acknowledges that community members are the best experts on their own lives and challenges.

The needs-based community development model and the principle of felt needs are interconnected and reinforce each other. The needs-based model offers a structured way to identify community needs, while the principle of felt needs ensures that these needs are genuinely relevant and prioritized by the community.

LO2 Adapt and incorporate best practices and trends to develop innovative social services programmes that meet the needs of clients or community stakeholders.

TSC

A7 Adapt and incorporate best practices and trends in programmes.

K4 Trends and best practices in social service programmes.

How does the AAC incorporate best practices and trends in its social service programs?

Social Service Program: Half-day morning workshop for elderly 60 or above who are at risk of social isolation.

Target population: elderly residents 60 or above residing in 123 Bukit Merah View

Problem: An increasing proportion of elderly is at-risk of social isolation. This may lead to other health and mental issues over the long term if not resolved.

Goal: Engage target group of seniors and encourage them to participate in activities at the Active Ageing Center (AAC).

Possible interventions: Befriending and buddying, constant engagement of seniors by staff and volunteers, and seniors' active participation in activities at the AAC.

Key points to consider:

A good fit: The half-day workshop is appropriate given the demographic profile and characteristics of the target community.

Address root cause: The workshop achieves the specific goals (after conducting a community needs assessment) of reducing incidences of social isolation among seniors. Community stakeholders, for example hospitals experience lower admission rates among the target group, and the AAC sees higher participating rates in its activities for seniors.

A good fit with the organization's mission and vision:

- NTUC Health Active Ageing Centres (AACs) operate with a focus on empowering seniors to lead independent, purpose-driven lives within a supportive community.

Vision

- **To Enable Ageless Seniors:** To help seniors live without the constraints of age, nurturing an "Ageless Senior" philosophy that encourages enthusiasm for living life to the fullest.
- **Vibrant Communities:** To build vibrant, connected communities where seniors thrive, connect, and shine.

Mission

- **Enhance Well-being:** To improve the overall well-being of seniors by developing community-based activities that promote active ageing.
- **Empowerment and Connection:** To shift from mere support to empowerment, ensuring seniors stay connected, active, and mentally sharp.
- **Inclusive Outreach:** To ensure every senior can access resources that enable them to live well at every stage of their life, including reaching out to frail or isolated seniors.

Key Pillars of Action (The "AAC Philosophy")

- **Be Connected:** Rediscover social connections.
- **Be Active:** Improve physical strength and flexibility
- **Be Sharp:** Engage the mind.

Availability of assets and resources: A team of full-time staff and volunteers, and the workshop venue have been made available for the workshop. The budget has been planned and approved by management.

What are some of the best practices adopted when implementing the half-day workshop?

Program Evaluation: A systematic way to monitor the effectiveness and cost-effectiveness of the half-day workshop (the program).

Some questions that the AAC considered:

- How effective was the program in meeting the needs of the target community of elderly seniors?
- How satisfied were the seniors of the program?
- Are the resources readily available for the program?
- Was the program implemented within budget?

Evaluation of the feasibility, effectiveness and cost-effectiveness of the half-day workshop with service and program parameters.

Service and program parameters define the success of the program. Success is when needs of the target community are met, and the community stakeholders are satisfied its assets and resources are well-utilized.

Program Feasibility: The strengths and weaknesses of the program are evaluated during the pilot run. Potential roadblocks are also identified early on to ensure the success of the program. The small number of participants (50) during the pilot run facilitated quick gathering of feedback with short, simple survey questionnaires after the workshop.

Program Effectiveness: 50% of seniors who participated in the workshop reported feeling less isolated and AAC activity registrations increased by over 25% in the six months following the workshop.

Program Cost-effectiveness: The expenses incurred for the workshop was well within the approved budget and the entire program was executed within the planned timeline of one month.

LO3 Develop strategies to engage the programme stakeholders in the social service sector to garner their support for the social service programmes or services.

TSC

K8 Strategies to engage programme stakeholders.

Strategies to Engage Program Stakeholders

The 4Cs strategies for stakeholder engagement.

- **Communicate**
- **Collaborate**
- **Control**
- **Commit**

Communicate a Shared Vision

Partnerships are guided by a shared vision and purpose. Alignment can also lead to improved coordination of members, programs, and policies. With a common vision, there is transparent and fluid communication among partners.

Collaborate as a Team

Productive collaboration is critical to drive initiatives successfully. In a partnership relationship, it is important to share the responsibility in leading the initiative.

Committed to the Project

A Memorandum of Understanding with a clearly articulated purpose, delegation of responsibilities, and task list leads to more successful partnerships.

Control Quality

Successful partnerships have structured leadership hierarchy and members are accountable for their actions.

Implementation Best Practices

- **Map and Prioritize:** Use power/interest grids to focus resources on the most critical stakeholders.
- **Two-Way Communication:** Ensure dialogue is not just informing, but listening and adapting.
- **Consistent Follow-Up:** Actively engage with difficult stakeholders to build trust.
- **Measure & Iterate:** Document interactions and use feedback to improve strategies continuously.

Effective stakeholder engagement frequently requires moving beyond just informing or consulting, and toward involving or collaborating for higher impact.